

Christopher Nichols

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Professional Summary

Software engineer with 20+ years in enterprise systems, targeting remote IBM i (AS/400) **COBOL** roles across finance, insurance, and government. Strengths include structured batch processing, SQL/data modeling, and modernization/integration that bridges legacy platforms with **web** and cloud **services**. Hands-on with ILE **COBOL**/COBOL-400, CL, embedded SQL (Db2 for i), DDS-based interactive and printer files, journaling/commitment control, and controlled releases. Comfortable supporting both steady-state maintenance and multi-phase modernization while collaborating with distributed teams.

Technical Skills

- IBM i / AS/400: ILE **COBOL** / **COBOL**-400, CL/CLLE, embedded SQL (Db2 for i), DDS (PF/LF/DSPF/PRTF), service programs/modules, journaling & commitment control, data & message queues, ACS/RDi/SEU/PDM, Query/400, job logs & spool management.
- Operations: Batch scheduling and monitoring, performance tuning, exception handling, root-cause **analysis**, secure promotion/change control.
- Data: SQL, data modeling, tuning (Db2 for i); additional experience with Oracle, SQL Server, and MySQL.
- Integration & Modernization: File and message interfaces, REST/SOAP gateways, ETL/feeds, secure data exchange; Git/Jenkins; Agile/Scrum collaboration.
- Security & Compliance: Object-level authorities, auditability/traceability, release documentation in regulated environments.

Professional Experience

Programmer Analyst III — Appriss/Apex Systems

Remote, Florida | Jan 2024 – Current

- Develop and maintain ILE **COBOL** batch processes with embedded SQL (Db2 for i) for high-volume credit data ingestion, transformation, and reporting.
- Author CL programs to orchestrate nightly job streams, manage dependencies, handle file transfers, and manage spool outputs.
- Tune SQL and file I/O to meet strict batch windows; monitor job logs and remediate exceptions to keep production cycles on time.
- Collaborate with analysts/QA/DBAs to deliver enhancements under change control; document program logic, runbooks, and release notes.
- **Support** modernization initiatives by exposing **COBOL** logic through controlled interfaces and structured extracts for analytics platforms.

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Sr. Cobol/Programmer Analyst — 3ci

Remote, GA | Jan 2023 – Dec 2023

- Extended **COBOL**-400 modules supporting utility billing and meter-read processing; implemented embedded SQL and optimized PF/LF access patterns.
- Built CL utilities and jobstreams for end-of-cycle processing and ad-hoc operations; created PRTF-based exception and reconciliation reports.
- Implemented data exchange between IBM i and distributed systems using files/queues and scheduled transfers with audit trails.
- Used RDi/SEU/PDM and source promotion workflows to manage code across DEV/TEST/PROD; reviewed code for standards and performance.
- Mentored teammates on IBM i development practices (journaling, commitment control, spool management, and joblog diagnostics).

Programmer Analyst II — Comcast / Pyramid

Duluth, GA | Mar 2022 – Dec 2022

- Supported subscriber-billing operations by enhancing **COBOL** programs and CL procedures for month-end and cycle billing tasks.
- Created and maintained DSPF/PRTF artifacts for operations dashboards and outbound statements; standardized spool naming and retention.
- Analyzed long-running jobs and optimized SQL access paths and file-level keys to improve throughput during peak cycles.
- Partnered with QA/ops to execute integration and regression tests; coordinated releases via formal change-management gates.

Cobol Programmer II — PNC Bank (Remote)

Oct 2021 – Mar 2022

- Exposed **COBOL** business rules through service endpoints to **support** digital banking features while preserving system-of-record integrity on IBM i.
- Maintained core batch (EOD) **COBOL**/SQL programs for postings, interest accruals, and statement generation; automated operational steps in CL.
- Collaborated with security/compliance on audit-ready logging and approvals for production promotions and hotfixes.

Programmer Analyst II — Home Depot (Remote)

Sep 2020 – Oct 2021

- Enhanced merchandising and inventory batch jobs in COBOL/400 with embedded SQL, processing large store and DC datasets nightly.
- Optimized logical file design and query strategies to reduce CPU and elapsed time for price/stock calculations and analytics feeds.
- Coordinated with data warehousing teams to publish validated extracts; established controls for reconciliation and error handling.

Sr. Cobol Programmer — WestRock

Duluth, GA | March 2018 – Sept 2020

- Maintained COBOL applications supporting manufacturing and inventory flows; leveraged journaling and commitment control for transactional integrity.
- Developed SQL-based extracts and utilities for downstream reporting; implemented standard error-handling and restart logic in batch steps.
- Participated in modernization to surface legacy data via services and controlled file interfaces, enabling analytics and mobile use cases.

Programmer Analyst II — AT&T

Alpharetta, GA | August 2015 – Mar 2018

- Delivered COBOL/CL utilities to automate network provisioning and inventory updates; produced printer-file audit and exception reports.
- Introduced promotion and deployment guardrails; worked with ops to standardize job logs, spool handling, and recovery procedures.

Cobol Programmer Analyst — General Motors

Roswell, GA | June 2006 – April 2015

- Developed enterprise features and collaborated with host teams to integrate with legacy data sources and batch/reporting processes.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science — Columbus State University, 2006

Christopher Nichols

- Naples, FL, US

Contact Information

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- 8505170433

Work History

Total Work Experience: 5 years

- **Cobol** Mainframe Programmer/**Developer** Appriss
Jan 01, 2020

Education

- **Bachelors** | Columbus State University

Skills

- **cobol** - 22 years
- **data ingestion** - 19 years
- **.net** - 18 years
- **structured query language** - 17 years
- **go** - 16 years
- **java** - 16 years
- **python** - 16 years
- **best practices** - 15 years
- **javascript** - 15 years
- **jenkins** - 14 years
- **qa** - 14 years
- **report generation** - 14 years
- **api** - 13 years

- **application programming interface** - 12 years
- **graphql** - 12 years
- **ibm db2** - 12 years
- **integration** - 12 years
- **offshoring** - 12 years
- **react** - 12 years
- **react native** - 12 years
- **software** - 12 years
- **agile** - 11 years
- **exception handling** - 10 years
- **extract, transform, load** - 10 years
- **full stack development** - 10 years
- **git** - 10 years
- **google cloud platform** - 10 years
- **ibm as400** - 10 years
- **microsoft sql server** - 10 years
- **mysql** - 10 years
- **personalization** - 10 years
- **websocket** - 10 years
- **.net framework** - 9 years
- **amazon web services** - 9 years
- **apache airflow** - 9 years
- **apache kafka** - 9 years
- **automation** - 9 years
- **c#** - 9 years
- **cross-functional** - 9 years
- **data modeling** - 9 years
- **devops** - 9 years
- **express** - 9 years
- **framework** - 9 years
- **machine learning** - 9 years
- **message queue** - 9 years
- **microservices** - 9 years
- **microsoft windows azure** - 9 years
- **node.js** - 9 years
- **oracle database** - 9 years
- **postgresql** - 9 years
- **real-time** - 9 years
- **redis** - 9 years
- **restful** - 9 years
- **spring** - 9 years
- **typescript** - 9 years
- **code review** - 8 years
- **documentation** - 8 years
- **mentorship** - 8 years

- **production** - 8 years
- **data analytics** - 7 years
- **docker** - 7 years
- **scrum** - 7 years
- **accessibility** - 6 years
- **collaboration** - 6 years
- **design patterns** - 6 years
- **elasticsearch, logstash, kibana** - 6 years
- **event-driven programming** - 6 years
- **feature engineering** - 6 years
- **fine-tuning** - 6 years
- **good practice** - 6 years
- **grafana** - 6 years
- **grpc** - 6 years
- **html5** - 6 years
- **integration testing** - 6 years
- **jest** - 6 years
- **kubernetes** - 6 years
- **mentoring** - 6 years
- **microsoft azure devops** - 6 years
- **mlflow** - 6 years
- **mlops** - 6 years
- **model development** - 6 years
- **mongodb** - 6 years
- **next.js** - 6 years
- **observability** - 6 years
- **prometheus** - 6 years
- **public relations** - 6 years
- **rendering** - 6 years
- **representational state transfer** - 6 years
- **search engine optimization** - 6 years
- **segmentation** - 6 years
- **source code** - 6 years
- **spring boot** - 6 years
- **storybook** - 6 years
- **tensorflow** - 6 years
- **code refactoring** - 5 years
- **enterprise software** - 5 years
- **github** - 5 years
- **iaas** - 5 years
- **leadership** - 5 years
- **management** - 5 years
- **predictive analytics** - 5 years
- **programming** - 5 years
- **software deployment** - 5 years

- **web services** - 5 years
- **spring framework** - 4 years
- **test-driven development** - 4 years
- **amazon dynamodb** - 3 years
- **continuous integration and continuous** - 3 years
- **quality assurance** - 3 years
- **soap** - 3 years
- **change control** - 2 years
- **file transfer protocol** - 2 years
- **optimization** - 2 years
- **windows operating system** - 2 years
- **.net core** - 1 years
- **agile ceremonies** - 1 years
- **amazon web services elastic compute** - 1 years
- **amazon web services lambda** - 1 years
- **cascading style sheets** - 1 years
- **chai** - 1 years
- **cloud functions** - 1 years
- **cloud native** - 1 years
- **content delivery network** - 1 years
- **cross-functional collaboration** - 1 years
- **cypress** - 1 years
- **databricks** - 1 years
- **devsecops** - 1 years
- **event-driven architecture** - 1 years
- **firebase** - 1 years
- **github actions** - 1 years
- **mocha** - 1 years
- **performance optimization** - 1 years
- **performance tuning** - 1 years
- **react router** - 1 years
- **root cause analysis** - 1 years
- **sass** - 1 years
- **serverless computing** - 1 years
- **team leadership** - 1 years
- **test automation** - 1 years
- **testing library** - 1 years
- **unsupervised learning** - 1 years
- **drupal** - 22 years
- **compliance** - 15 years
- **security** - 15 years
- **ui** - 15 years
- **business requirements** - 14 years
- **cloud** - 14 years
- **government** - 14 years

- **public sector** - 14 years
- **responsive design** - 14 years
- **wcag** - 14 years
- **asp.net** - 9 years
- **ecs** - 9 years
- **http** - 9 years
- **php** - 9 years
- **scalability** - 9 years
- **migration** - 8 years
- **unit testing** - 8 years
- **angularjs** - 7 years
- **jasmine** - 7 years
- **scripting** - 7 years
- **spa** - 7 years
- **automated testing** - 5 years
- **thread** - 5 years
- **hibernate** - 4 years
- **amazon ec2** - 2 years
- **amazon s3** - 2 years
- **ibm i** - 17 years
- **css** - 15 years
- **billing** - 10 years
- **command-line interface** - 10 years
- **data interchange** - 10 years
- **product data management** - 10 years
- **bootstrap** - 5 years
- **reconciliation** - 3 years
- **scala** - 3 years
- **distributed systems** - 1 years
- **elasticsearch** - 1 years
- **play framework** - 1 years
- **logging** - 10 years
- **regression testing** - 10 years
- **database** - 7 years
- **jira** - 4 years
- **business logic** - 3 years
- **batch processing** - 20 years
- **software engineering** - 20 years
- **middleware** - 6 years
- **data warehousing** - 2 years
- **error handling** - 2 years
- **merchandising** - 2 years
- **fabrication** - 3 years
- **use cases** - 3 years
- **software development** - 14 years

- **engineering** - 7 years
- **apex data loader** - 6 years
- **angular** - 4 years
- **amazon** **simple storage service** - 3 years
- **amazon** **web services** **api gateway** - 3 years
- **amazon** **web services** **elastic mapreduce** - 3 years
- **apache spark** - 3 years
- **automated machine learning** - 3 years
- **automation anywhere** - 3 years
- **build automation** - 3 years
- **data quality** - 3 years
- **fastlane** - 3 years
- **hashicorp vault** - 3 years
- **internet of things** - 3 years
- **react hooks** - 3 years
- **scikit-learn** - 3 years
- **testflight** - 3 years
- **web** **content accessibility guidelines** - 3 years
- **xgboost** - 3 years
- **code coverage** - 3 years
- **provisioning** - 3 years
- **hosting** - 8 years
- **application performance** - 7 years
- **ab testing** - 3 years
- **android** - 3 years
- **authorization** - 3 years
- **fast healthcare interoperability** - 3 years
- **flask** - 3 years
- **health insurance portability and** - 3 years
- **health level seven** - 3 years
- **ios** - 3 years
- **json** **web** **token** - 3 years
- **mean stack** - 3 years
- **microsoft azure** - 3 years
- **microsoft disk operating system** - 3 years
- **mobile application** - 3 years
- **oscilloscope** - 3 years
- **pytorch** - 3 years
- **redux toolkit** - 3 years
- **visual studio team** **services** - 3 years
- **jquery** - 4 years
- **easytrieve** - 6 years
- **ivr** - 4 years
- **com** - 3 years
- **apache hbase** - 4 years

- **apache storm** - 4 years
- **data preprocessing** - 4 years
- **data validation** - 4 years
- **front-end development** - 4 years
- **google cloud compute engine** - 4 years
- **hypertext transfer protocol** - 4 years
- **prototyping** - 4 years
- **refactoring** - 4 years
- **resource allocation** - 4 years
- **spring model-view-controller** - 4 years
- **user experience design** - 4 years
- **html** - 13 years
- **cvs** - 11 years
- **eclipse** - 11 years
- **upgrades** - 4 years
- **ant** - 10 years
- **administration** - 9 years
- **database administration** - 7 years
- **dhtml** - 3 years
- **application development** - 14 years
- **c** - 4 years
- **ibm lotus domino** - 3 years
- **analysis** - 9 years
- **cics** - 6 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: Remote
- Likely to Switch: True
- Willing to Relocate: False
- Travel Preference: 0%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US Citizen
- Security Clearance: False
- Desired Hourly Rate: 85+ (USD)
- Desired Salary: 155,000+ (USD)
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Part-time

- Contract - W2
- Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/christopher-nichols-6106b237a>
- Dice:
<https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/c8b6b5a15063b12e688ebdf00d8d913a>